Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-11-09

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Amos 4:1-13

1 Hear this word, you cows of Bashan, who are on the mountain of Samaria, Who oppress the poor, Who crush the needy, Who say to your husbands, “Bring wine, let us drink!”

2 The Lord God has sworn by His holiness: “Behold, the days shall come upon you When He will take you away with fishhooks, And your posterity with fishhooks.

3 You will go out through broken walls, Each one straight ahead of her, And you will be cast into Harmon,” Says the Lord.

4 “Come to Bethel and transgress, At Gilgal multiply transgression; Bring your sacrifices every morning, Your tithes every three days.

5 Offer a sacrifice of thanksgiving with leaven, Proclaim and announce the freewill offerings; For this you love, You children of Israel!” Says the Lord God.

6 “Also I gave you cleanness of teeth in all your cities, And lack of bread in all your places; Yet you have not returned to Me,” Says the Lord.

7 “I also withheld rain from you, When there were still three months to the harvest. I made it rain on one city, I withheld rain from another city. One part was rained upon, And where it did not rain the part withered.

8 So two or three cities wandered to another city to drink water, But they were not satisfied; Yet you have not returned to Me,” Says the Lord.

9 “I blasted you with blight and mildew. When your gardens increased, Your vineyards, Your fig trees, And your olive trees, The locust devoured them; Yet you have not returned to Me,” Says the Lord.

10 “I sent among you a plague after the manner of Egypt; Your young men I killed with a sword, Along with your captive horses; I made the stench of your camps come up into your nostrils; Yet you have not returned to Me,” Says the Lord.

11 “I overthrew some of you, As God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah, And you were

like a firebrand plucked from the burning; Yet you have not returned to Me,” Says the Lord.

12 “Therefore thus will I do to you, O Israel; Because I will do this to you, Prepare to meet your God, O Israel!”

13 For behold, He who forms mountains, And creates the wind, Who declares to man what his thought is, And makes the morning darkness, Who treads the high places of the earth— The Lord God of hosts is His name.

II. Key Summary

• The Lord calls the people on the mountain of Samaria "cows of Bashan," who oppress the poor, crush the needy, and say to their husbands, "Bring wine, let us drink!" The Lord God swears by His holiness that they will be taken away with fishhooks, go out through broken walls, and be cast into Harmon (vv. 1–3).

• The Lord says, "Come to Bethel and transgress, at Gilgal multiply transgression": bring sacrifices every morning, tithes every three days, and proclaim the freewill offerings, "for this you love" (vv. 4–5).

• The Lord lists hunger, withheld rain, blight and locusts, plague and sword, and overthrown cities, and after each one says, "Yet you have not returned to Me." He ends with "Prepare to meet your God," whose name is the Lord God of hosts (vv. 6–13).

III. Passage Analysis

"For This You Love"

> The children of Israel loved their corrupted worship. It was disobedient both in heart and action, but they loved it. It's always wrong to measure worship by how it pleases us because it is possible for corrupt and disobedient worship to be "wonderfully" pleasing. [1]

The Lord says, "Come to Bethel… at Gilgal": bring sacrifices every morning, tithes every three days, a thanksgiving offering with leaven, and proclaim the freewill offerings, and then He adds, "for this you love" (vv. 4–5). In the same verses He calls all of it "transgress" and "multiply transgression" (v. 4).

They worshiped often and loudly, but in the way they themselves loved.

"Yet You Have Not Returned to Me"

> It is five times repeated in these verses, as the burden of the charge, "Yet have you not returned unto me, saith the Lord; you have been several times corrected, but in vain; you are not reclaimed, there is no sign of amendment. You have been sent for by one messenger after another, but you have not come back, you have not come home." [2]

In the previous passage (3:14) the Lord said He would punish the altars of Bethel; here the people still go to Bethel (v. 4). Then come hunger, no rain, locusts eating the gardens, plague, and overthrown cities, one after another, and each is followed by the same line: "Yet you have not returned to Me" (vv. 6–11).

They went to Bethel every morning, but never once came back to God.

IV. Reflection Question

When you go to church or pray, how do you know whether you're coming back to God, or just doing what you like?

Israel went to Bethel every day and offered diligently, and the Lord said, "for this you love" (vv. 4–5); after five disasters, what the Lord still said was, "Yet you have not returned to Me" (vv. 6–11).

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Amos 4 – "Yet You Have Not Returned to Me", https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/amos-4/

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Commentary (Amos 4), https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/Amo/Amo_004.cfm